



Plumber

plumber • 4-5 year apprenticeship

\$55K-\$75K / yr

THE TRADE

Install and repair water supply, drainage, and gas systems that keep buildings safe and habitable. Plumbers work across residential, commercial, and industrial sites with year-round demand and a clear ladder from journeyman to master license and your own shop.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$55K-\$75K

BLS median \$59,880 (blog-cited) • apprentice 4-5 yr, ~8,000 OJT hrs • master plumbers run \$75K-\$100K+

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



Plumber — Roadmap, page 2

CERTIFICATIONS + FIRST 12 WEEKS

REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

OSHA 10 Hour — the universal entry credential

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm that you are fit for your OSHA 10 online
- ☐ Get First Aid/CPR certified
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Call a local UA hall for intake dates
- ☐ Search apprenticeship.gov plumbing
- ☐ Buy basics: pipe wrench, adjustable wrench
- ☐ Learn to read a rough-in plumbing print
- ☐ Shadow a plumber for half a day
- ☐ Apply to 3 union or private programs
- ☐ Practice the intake math and reading
- ☐ Get test references before interviews

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>